[METRIC]
A-A-2890A
February 27, 1998
Superseding
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November 14, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PAD, EASEL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all federal agencies.

1. **SCOPE.** This description covers easel or wall (lecture) pads.

2. **CLASSIFICATION.** Easel Pads covered by this Commercial Item Description shall be of the following styles.

Style:
A Plain
B 2.54 cm (1") Squares
C Ruled

3. **SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.**

3.1 Materials. The paper shall be white or yellow, and made from not less than 95% bleached chemical pulp.

3.2 Physical Requirements. The paper shall conform to the physical requirements of Table I.

Table I

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Basis Weight (17X22-500) Avg. g/m^2 (lbs), +/- 5%	75 (20)	T410
Bursting strength, kpa avg., min. (psi)	138 (20)	T403
Opacity, percent, min	85	T425

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7530

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3.2.1 Writing quality. The paper shall be sufficiently sized to accept fountain pen ink writing without feathering or ink penetration through to the opposite side of the sheet when tested as follows. Draw several lines and characters on both surfaces of the paper with a medium point (commercial type) fountain pen using a one percent aqueous solution of Acid Red 1 Color Index Number 18050 or Acid Green 3 Color Index Number 42085. The characters shall be clear cut and shall not feather. The Acid Red 1 or the Acid Green 3 may be obtained from Pylam products, International Dyestuffs Corp., Sandoz, Incorporated and Ciba-Geigy Chemical Corp.

3.2.2 Color. The color of the sheets shall be specified in the ordering data. All the sheets in a pad shall be the same color.

3.3 Backing. The pad backing shall be chipboard or other suitable paperboard which shall conform to Table II.

Table II

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Thickness, min. mm (inch)	0.8 (0.030)	T411
Bursting strength, avg. min. kpa (psi)	380 (55)	T807

3.4 Size. The pads shall have minimum overall dimensions of 0.685 m x 0.864 m (27" x 34") and shall not exceed 0.699 m x 0.902m (27 1/2" x 35 1/2"). The first dimension given is the horizontal dimension.

3.5 Rulings. The sheets shall be ruled or unruled, as specified in the ordering data. When specified for Style B, the pads shall be ruled 2.54 cm (1") squares. A tolerance of +/- 1.6 mm (+/- 1/16") shall be permitted between rulings. When specified for Style C, the sheets shall be ruled with lines on the face side only. Rulings shall start 2.54 cm (1") from the perforation at the top of the sheet, +/- 1/4" and end 3/4" from the bottom of the sheet +/-1/4". Lines shall be spaced one inch apart +/- 1.6 mm (+/- 1/16").

3.6 Ink. The ruling ink shall be blue. The ruling shall be continuous and uniform without waviness or feathering of the lines.

3.7 Assembly of pads. Each pad shall contain not less than fifty sheets of paper. The sheets shall have a backing sheet of equal size, +/-1.6 mm (+/- 1/16"), and a front reinforcing strip of the same material. The front reinforcing strip shall run the full width of the pad and shall extend 3.0 cm +/- 3.2 mm (1 3/16", +/- 1/8") from the top edge of the pad. A minimum of four staples shall fasten together the front reinforcing strip, sheet, and backing sheets.

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A cloth binding strip, of the type used commercially for this purpose, shall be firmly adhered to the backing, top edge, and reinforcing strip. The cloth binding shall cover the front reinforcing strip, +0.8 mm, -1.6 mm (+1/32", -1/16"), and shall extend and cover the full width of the backing sheet for a distance of not less than 1.27 cm (1/2") from the top edge.

The cloth binding shall be attached with a suitable adhesive. The sheets shall be perforated across the width of the pad. The perforations shall be parallel to the bottom edge of the reinforcing strip and shall not fall under the strip nor be located beyond the bottom edge of the strip by more than 1.6 mm (1/16"). The top assembly, as described above, shall be punched with two holes. The holes shall have a diameter of 8.0 mm +/- 1.6 mm (5/16", +/- 1/16") and shall be spaced 44.5 cm +/- 1.6 mm (17 1/2", +/- 1/16") center to center, located equidistant from the nearest sides. The holes shall be placed 1.27 cm +/- 1.6 mm (1/2", +/- 1/16") hole center to top edge of the pad.

3.8 Workmanship. All edges of the paper shall be smoothly and evenly cut. Paper shall be free from holes, tears, wrinkles, dirt, foreign matter, or other defects.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENT. The contractor shall certify that the product offered shall contain a minimum of 20% postconsumer fiber as defined by the Paper Products Recovered Materials Advisory Notice (Paper RMAN) and the Executive Order 12995 dated March 25, 1996. The Paper RMAN is found in the Federal Register, Vol 61, Part IV dated May 29, 1996. The pad backing offered shall include a minimum of 90% postconsumer recovered materials, in accordance with CFR 40 part 250. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.1 Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves to right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial it description. The quality of the product sold to the government shall be equal to or better than the quality of t product sold by the manufacturer in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require pr such conformance.

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5.2 Testing. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the referenced tests in the commercial Item Description. (Note: See TAPPI T400 for specific sampling instructions and acceptance criteria.)

6. PACKAGING, PACKING, LABELING AND MARKING. packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Referenced Documents. The referenced documents in effect on the date of solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

7.1.1 TAPPI test methods are available from: Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348 (404) 209-7276.

7.1.2 The Final (Paper RMAN) is available from EPA'S public access server on the Internet or from the RCRA Hotline. The Hotline can be reached toll-free at (800) 424-9346. Copy of Executive Order 12995 is available from:

The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building
White House, Attn.: Publications, Washington DC. 20500, telephone (202)395-7332.

7.1.3 The Code of Federal Regulations, Title 40, Protection of Environment, Part 250 may be purchased from the Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402, phone(202)783-3238.

7.1.4 Copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications are available from: Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specification Section (3FPB-W), Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407, phone (202)619-8925.

7.2 Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

1. Title, number and date of this Commercial Item Description

2. Size and Color

3. Non-Chlorine bleaching is required

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4. Specific, Packaging, Packing, Marking and Palletization.

8. LIST OF NSNs.

7530-01-398-2661 7530-00-619-8880

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE. DOD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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